to provide a new understanding of this changing equation. This section also outlines the role of Sangh Parivar outfits, in particular the Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram, in mobilising tribal groups in favour of the BJP's political project.

The party may appear like a political monolith, but its geographies of influence vary a great deal across India. Under the veneer of a uniformist ideology, the BJP operates very differently in different parts of the country. The final part of this book traces the differences in the BJP's growth story in two new catchments areas: its southern-states model, where the party's mobilisation and appeal is very different from its core areas in the Hindi heartland, and its model of mergers and acquisitions in the north-eastern states of India. A party's failures tell us as much as its successes. In particular, this section examines the BJP's strategies of expansion in Karnataka—home to India's Silicon Valley, Bengaluru—and whether they can be replicated in other states like Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh or Telangana. Similarly, the Northeast, home to Assam, a state with India's largest proportion of Muslims after Kashmir, and several states with Christian majorities, offers a different model of adaptability and tactical alliances for a party that, in north India, is suffused with Hindu messaging and a religiosity that is central to its politics.

Identities of influence matter as much as geographies. The book closes with a study of how the BJP specifically focuses on rural women voters, and examines the cross-cutting national cleavage of gender. A shift in the overall women vote towards the party has driven the BJP's recent growth story. The last part of the book examines how this occurred, how the party dealt with questions of gender and what this portends for the future.

Critics and Opposition leaders have often argued that this new BJP-dominated India puts the country's democracy in danger. The Congress's P. Chidambaram summed up this critique in early 2019 when he argued that 'fear is dominating India', that key institutions of the state had been captured by the ruling party. As he put it, 'people tell me that they think twice. Before they email, they think twice and they think even more before picking up a phone. Democracy is in danger.'[15] The BJP, of course, denies such charges. While its